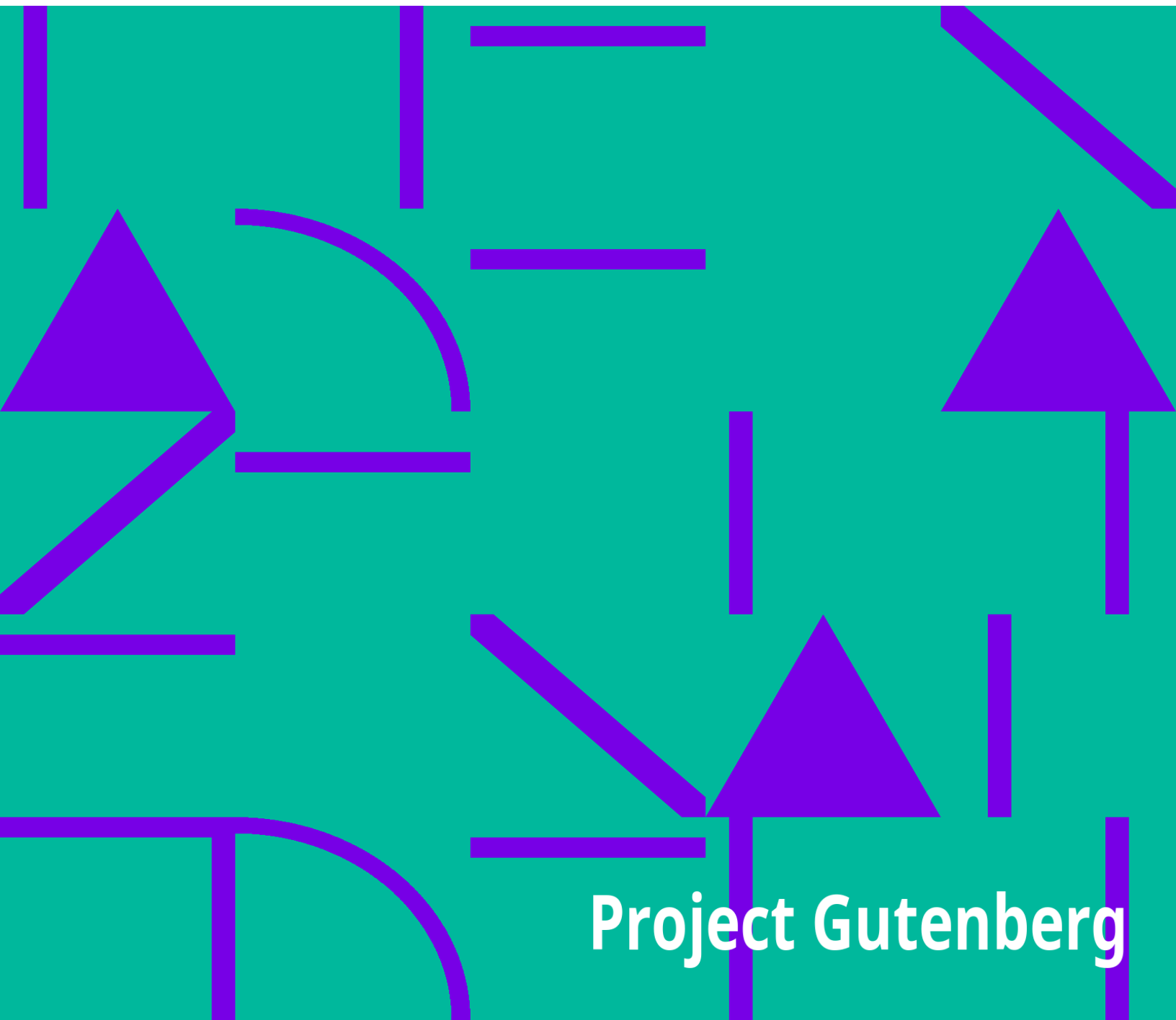


The Maid and the Magpie

Charles Moreton



Project Gutenberg

The Maid and the Magpie

Charles Moreton



Project Gutenberg

The Project Gutenberg eBook of The Maid and the Magpie

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: The Maid and the Magpie

Author: Charles Moreton

Release date: July 30, 2007 [eBook #22181]

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/22181

Credits: E-text prepared by Janet Blenkinship and the Project Gutenberg Online Distributed Proofreading Team (<http://www.pgdp.net>) from digital material generously made available by Internet Archive/American Libraries (<http://www.archive.org/details/americana>)

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE MAID AND
THE MAGPIE ***

**E-text prepared by Janet Blenkinship
and the Project Gutenberg Online Distributed Proofreading Team**

(<http://www.pgdp.net>)
from digital material generously made available by
Internet Archive/American Libraries
(<http://www.archive.org/details/americana>)

Note: Images of the original pages are available through Internet
Archive/American Libraries. See
<http://www.archive.org/details/maidthemagpieint00moreiala>

(THE)
MAID and the MAGPIE
an Interesting Tale
Founded on Facts.
By Charles Meriton



LONDON.
*Published by G. Stevens,
10, Borough Road, Southwark.*



FRONTISPIECE.

Verse [4](#)

THE MAID and the MAGPIE

an Interesting Tale

Founded on Facts

By Charles Moreton

LONDON.

Published by G. Stevens, 10 Borough Road, Southwark.



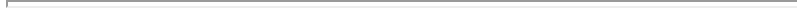
Verse [16](#)

THE

MAID

AND THE

MAGPIE.



1

At Palaiseau, there liv'd a maid,
In form and features mild;
The stings of conscience never prey'd,
On this devoted child.

2

She serv'd a wealthy farmer there,
An honest soul was he;
Her comforts were his only care,
And all he wish'd to see.

3

His wife was of another mould,
And prematurely smart;
Hasty, and rash, with that a scold,
Yet still a feeling heart.

4

One summers eve', her labor done,
She sat in pensive plight;
Watching the clear declining sun,
With rapt'rous delight.

5

'Twas then, that Blaisot trembling came
And sitting by her side;
Ventur'd to declare his flame,
And ask her for his bride.

6

He told his tale of tender love,
Then on her hand he sigh'd!
Annette she blush'd, her love to prove
And with his suit complied.

7

In mutual flame, their bosoms burn,
He steals a rapt'rous kiss;
When soon old Juliannes return,
Destroy'd the lovers bliss.

8

By Farm-house door in wicker cage,
A Magpie hung to view;
Whose prattling tongue would oft
assuage,
The melancholy few.

9

Julianne now strict orders made,
To clean up all the plate;
Annette her orders quick obey'd
And sought the outer gate.

10

Her Father who was sadly poor,
And wander'd heedless were;
Just at the moment reach'd the door,
In wild, and deep despair.

11

His wretched form, she knew full well,
His voice she knew as soon;
Her feelings now what pen can tell,
She dropt both fork and spoon.

12

She rush'd distracted to his arms,
In extacy of joy;
Nor dreamt that scoffs and rude alarms
Would e'er her peace destroy.

13

When at this moment from his hold,
The Magpie swiftly flew;
He seiz'd the spoon: ah! wretch so bold,
And dragg'd it from their view.

14

Swift to the Abbey then he sped,
Borne on the buoyant air;
Nor ever thought that as he fled,
Annette his guilt would bear.



Verse [32](#)

15

Look up my child and view me here,
One lost to all his clan;
My enemies, alas! are near,
To claim a wretched man.

16

Then on his neck the fair one fell,
A victim to despair;
He strove her fondness to dispell,
Her grief he could not bear.

17

Just at this moment past the door,
A wretch to feelings blind;
He view'd the guest, and saw him poor,
And therefore prov'd unkind.

18

What wretched man is that I see
In garb so sad and torn?
A weary traveller, said she,
Who wanders here forlorn.

19

Come hither girl,——come hither lass,
Said justice with a smile;
Come cheer your spirits with a glass,
Each anxious hour beguile.

20

She saw his motive, knew his aim,
Her heart was elsewhere plac'd;
Her Blaisot's form, her Blaisot's name,
Was no where to be trac'd.

21

Just at this pause, there enter'd straight,
His worships clerk with speed;
With papers relative to fate,
Or some foul bloody deed.

22

Read this my child, the justice said,
And tell me what they say;
Judge what she felt; ah! luckless maid,
Now think of her dismay.



Verse [44](#)

23

Her Fathers name was couple'd there,
With death and sore disgrace;
“Desertion” was his crime,—dispair
Was written in her face.

24

She urg'd the justice from the spot,
And he at length compli'd;
She trembel'd for a parents lot,
She wept, she sobb'd, she cried.

25

Her Fathers heart, by fears opprest,
He stagger'd to a chair;
He falter'd, spoke, then on her breast,
He fell in wild dispair.

26

Oh! pitying Heav'n, preserve my child
Preserve her God from ill;
Then I in accents soft and mild
Will bear thy tortures still.

27

Then from his belt a fork and spoon
He plac'd before her view;
He paus'd, before he ask'd the boon,
While tears his cheeks bedew.

28

Take these sad relicks, all I hold,
The wreck of fortune lost;
And quick exchange them love for gold,
For one by fortune crost.

29

Thy form I must not see again,
Then mark my last decree;
The gold that these, my love obtain,
Convey to yonder tree.

30

This said, he vanished from her sight,
She sank, opprest with grief;
Her eyes were dim, tho' azure bright,
And tears bestow'd relief.

31

Her heart reliev'd, she sought with speed,
Her promise to pursue;
When chance directed in her need,
A wandering pedlar Jew.

32

Her Fathers wealth to him she sold,
But heav'd a bitter sigh;
And as she took the glittering gold,
A tear bedim'd her eye.

33

The Jew was gone! she rush'd with joy,
To seek the hollow tree;
Delighted that she'd soon destroy
His cares and set him free.

34

But fate denied her good intent,
Julianne came that way;
And stop'd her course, on virtue bent,
And caus'd a short delay.

35

Come hither child, the matron said,
I've business here for you;
'Tis fit the plate be instant laid,
Ere you your course pursue.

36

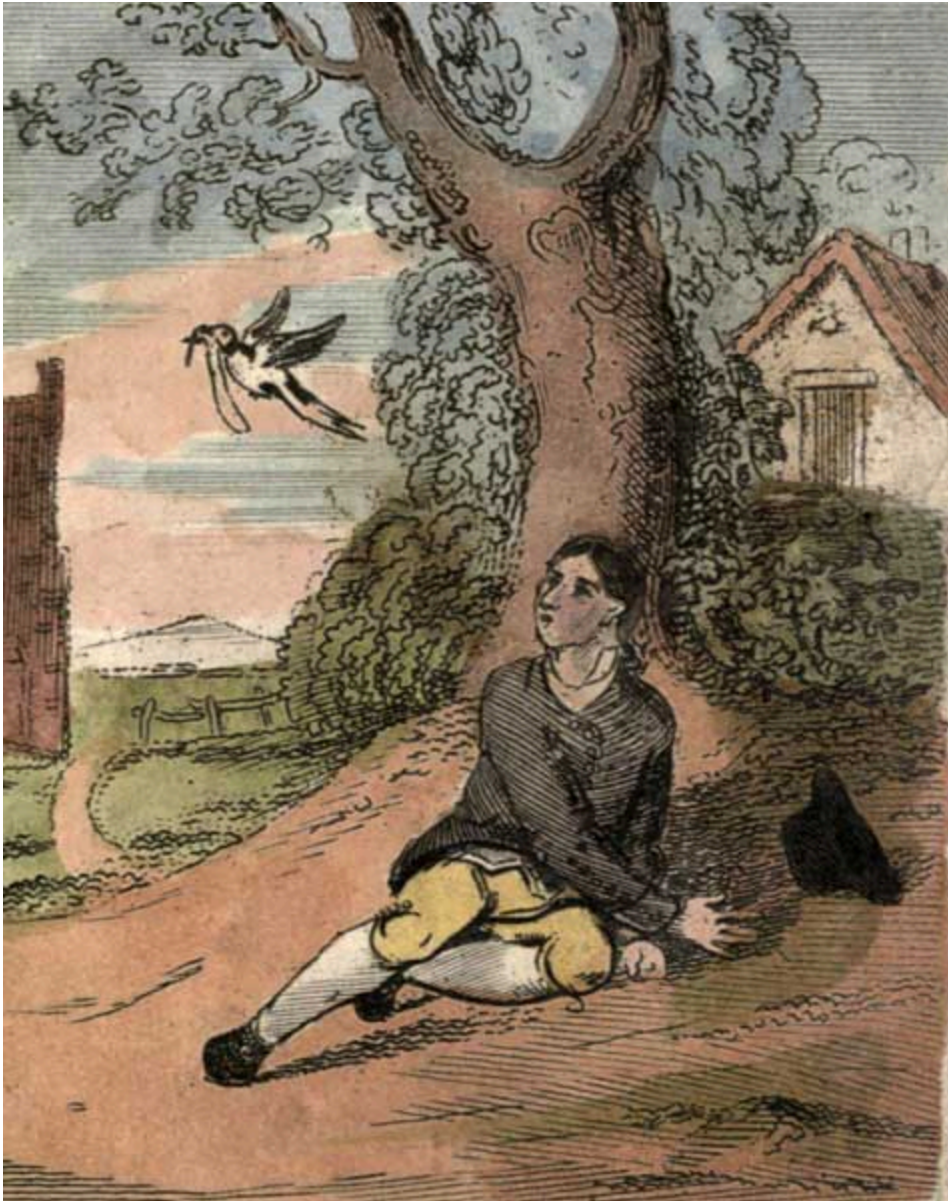
She counted o'er each massy spoon,
When dreadful to relate;
The one deficient, very soon,
She miss'd among her plate.

37

Dispair was mark'd in Annette's face
Which beam'd deep scarlet hue;
Where heav'nly innocence might trace,
A heart, both firm and true.

38

'Tis passing strange, Annette then sigh'd,
When Gerard reach'd the door;
But whose the Thief? the Magpie cry'd,
Annette, and said no more.



Verse [51](#)

39

'Tis laughable, old Gerard said,
And smiling as he spoke;
That Mag should call his fav'rite maid,
And well enjoy'd the joke.

40

It may be so, said Julianne too,
But ominous I wot;
But here's the justice—out she flew.
And brought him to the spot.

41

The case was told, he shook his head,
Annette was prov'd the thief;
Each eye was now with tears o'er shed,
With tears of poignant grief.

42

They urg'd her to confess the deed,
I'm innocent she cry'd!
In vain her Blaisot tried to plead,
But, "mercy" all denied.

43

Immoveable the laws command,
No treaties could prevail;
They seiz'd Annette with desp'rate hand,
Her fate they all bewail.

44

Immur'd within a dungeons gloom,
She waits the destin'd blow;
Tho' innocent, the culprits doom,
Must end her ev'ry woe.

45

Her trial came,——Annette was cast,
Each heard it with a sigh;
And now their ev'ry hope was past,
Annette was doom'd to die.

46

Her dreary moments, who can tell,
Till Blaisot met her view;
They wept, they sigh'd, when Annettes
knell
Proclaim'd their last adieu.



Verse [56](#)

47

Then from her neck, a cross she took,
And gave it kisses three;
Receive from one, by hope forsook,
A gift design'd for thee.

48

He trembling took the proffer'd prize,
Forebodings shook his frame;
A flood of tears bedim'd his eyes,
He bless'd the givers name.

49

With down cast look, and heavy heart,
He homeward bent his way;
He tax'd the fates, that love could part,
Or cause such sad dismay.

50

Just as he reached his Fathers cot,
The once abode of rest;
His nature ev'ry care forgot,
He sank by grief opprest.

51

And has his form extended lay,
The cross was fair to view;
The Magpie seiz'd it for his prey,
And to the Abbey flew.

52

His worships clerk observ'd the theft,
And told him of his loss;
The dormant youth was now bereft
Of reason and his cross.

53

Now swiftly to the spot he flew,
The Abbey enter'd soon;
His valu'd cross, now met his view,
With it, the fork and spoon.

54

With joy he seized the stolen plate,
His bliss, what tongue can tell;
He wonder'd, gaz'd, till rous'd by fate,
And Annette's dying knell.

55

He starting, trembel'd at the sound——
Again it struck his ear;
With lightening speed he struck the
ground
To save his only dear.

56

In solemn state, Annette was led,
Towards the fatal spot;
All pray'd a blessing on her head,
Her guilt they all forgot.

57

Old Gerard sought in vain to spare
Her life, her destin'd fate;
When Blaisot entered in dispair,
And shew'd the stollen plate.

58

A shout of joy, now rent the sky,
Old Gerard join'd the pair;
Erect they stand, who guilt defy,
The guilty do not dare,

59

Before the sun, with bended knee,
They sank with awful fear;
With praises to their Lord's decree,
They sought their cottage cheer.

60

Her Father, he now met their view,
Past cares they all defied;
The maid was spar'd, her virtue too,
The Magpie 'twas that died.



Verse [60](#)

FINIS.

L. H. Cox, Printer, 17, Black Friars Road.

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK THE MAID AND
THE MAGPIE ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg™ License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.